

**The University of Tennessee, Knoxville
Nuclear Engineering Graduate Student Assembly
Constitution**

**Date of Origin: July 2019
Date of Constitution Revision: March 2020**

ARTICLE I: Name and Mission

Section I: Name

The name of this organization shall be the **Nuclear Engineering Graduate Student Assembly**.

Section II: Mission

The mission of the Nuclear Engineering Graduate Student Assembly is to serve as a collaborative forum that enables University of Tennessee graduate students in the Nuclear Engineering Department to initiate and engage in discussions, events, and programs hosted by the organization to better the department and its graduate students.

ARTICLE II: Organizational Structure

Section I: Executive Board Positions

The following Executive Board position descriptions detail the base expectations of each office. By accepting an Executive Board role, the officer is understanding that he/she may be relied upon to generally advance and contribute to the organization in miscellaneous ways not explicitly stated here. The officer reserves the right to refrain from participating in any activities without consequence, based upon personal/religious beliefs, personal values, or moral reserve as defined by the officer.

Each Executive Board position term is defined to be fulfilled after one calendar year since the most recent regular election. Each position is limited to one officer and each officer is limited to one position.

1. President

- i. Shall preside over all organizational meetings and propose (and adjust) meeting frequency.
- ii. Shall review all activities and programs.
- iii. Shall reserve the power to create additional temporary Executive Board positions in addition to the ones described here by appointment and also the power to release that person from duty by unanimous agreement from the

remaining officers. If the position's responsibilities will last longer than 6 meetings, the person must be approved as a new officer of the organization by the membership by a majority vote.

iv. Shall reserve the power to revise the Constitution after consulting with the Executive Board. The decision must be unanimous.

v. Shall serve as the point of contact between the Nuclear Engineering Department and the organization. The President shall also be the primary contact between the organization and the advisor.

2. Vice-President

i. If the President can no longer fulfill his/her duties, the Vice-President shall assume the full presidency and a vote among the membership, with one meeting's notice, will follow to replace the absent roles.

ii. Shall act as the liaison between the membership and the President in suggesting Constitutional changes, major events, etc.

iii. Shall serve as a supporting role to the President.

3. Public Relations Chair

i. Shall be responsible for reserving an appropriate meeting place for general meetings as well as other occurrences in a timely manner.

ii. Shall lead and organize the recruitment efforts of the organization.

iii. Shall organize events such as, but not limited to, the Nuclear Engineering New Graduate Student Orientation as well as any workshops hosted by the organization.

iv. Shall manage any outward-facing programs, such as, but not limited to, social media accounts.

4. Treasurer

i. Shall collect and handle all organization funds, including any membership dues.

ii. Shall record who has paid any membership dues.

iii. Shall make all organization purchases once approved by the Executive Board.

iv. Shall be generally responsible for handling all monetary related activities conducted by the organization.

Section II: Executive Board Eligibility

To qualify for an Executive Board position, the person must be a graduate student in the University of Tennessee, Knoxville's Nuclear Engineering Department. The person must be a member of the organization for at least 2/3 of two consecutive semesters. The person must also be successfully elected to the position. The definition of a successful election is provided later.

Section III: Advisor

1. The advisor must be a full-time Nuclear Engineering faculty member at the University of Tennessee, Knoxville. The advisor is welcome, but not required, to attend organizational meetings.
2. The advisor reserves the right to call a meeting with the Executive Board to discuss any concerns, questions, or advice he/she would like to provide as it pertains to the organization.
3. The advisor's primary role is to offer feedback and advice regarding the general direction of the organization as well as input on specific organization occurrences.
4. In the instance of the violations of Constitutional policies and/or a conflict between members within the organization the highest ranking officer that is not involved with the conflict, with assistance from the advisor, will facilitate the mediation process.
5. The organization will choose a new advisor through a majority vote of the Executive Board.

Section IV: Filling Unexpired Vacancies

1. Nominations are taken at the meeting following the vacancy. Elections also occur at this meeting.
2. If a majority (50%+1) is not obtained by any of the candidates, the candidate receiving the lowest number of votes is eliminated, and the active members shall vote again.
3. When nominations are being taken to fill unexpired terms, any member of the organization may nominate another member of the organization, including themselves, by simply raising his/her hand and indicating such when recognized.

ARTICLE III: Membership

Section I: Non-Discrimination/ Same-Sex Organizations

1. Membership is be open to all students, regardless of race, color, national origin, religion, sex, pregnancy, marital status, sexual orientation, gender identity, age, physical or mental disability, or covered veteran status.

- Same Sex Organization, requirements:
 - Registered student organizations, including those affiliated with an extramural organization shall be open to all students - unless the organization, by its nature, exists explicitly for a certain subgroup - in selecting its membership. The U.S Department of Education Office of Civil Rights has established clear criteria for exemption from Title IX for student organizations. The criteria is as follows:
 - The organization must have tax-exempt status under Section 501 of the Internal Revenue Code
 - Members must be limited to students, staff, or faculty at the University of Tennessee
 - The organization must be a “social fraternity or sorority” as defined by the United States Department of Education

2. A member of the Nuclear Engineering Graduate Student Assembly is defined as any student at the University of Tennessee, Knoxville in good academic standing and who is a graduate student in the Nuclear Engineering Department.

3. An active member is defined as a member who has paid membership dues. All memberships terminate at the start of each fall semester and must be renewed annually to maintain active status. A member may become active at any time, but all active memberships must be renewed at the beginning of each fall semester.

4. All members, including but not limited to new members and recruits, reserve the right to refrain from participating in any activities without consequence, based upon personal/religious beliefs, personal values, or moral reserve as defined by the member.

ARTICLE IV: Procedures

Section I: Meetings

1. The Nuclear Engineering Graduate Student Assembly shall take place at a regular time and location, after consultation with the advisors and members. Meetings are expected to occur monthly.

2. All general meetings of the Nuclear Engineering Graduate Student Assembly, except for those that contain confidential information, shall be open to any graduate student in the Nuclear Engineering department at the University of Tennessee, Knoxville.

Section II: Voting

1. Only active members may vote.
2. Quorum for all voting shall be seventy-five percent (75%) of the active membership.
3. A simple majority (50% +1) shall be necessary for all successful voting. This majority shall be derived from the active members present.

Section III: Elections

1. Elections shall take place during a planned meeting during the spring semester.
2. This conditions and date for the election meeting shall be publicized in the meetings preceding it.
3. Elections codes:
 - i. Any member may nominate an active member, including him/herself, for any office by entering his/her name at the appropriate time determined by the presiding official. Next, the active members shall cast secret, written ballots for the candidate of their choice during the election meeting. Each active member shall have one vote per office.
 - ii. If 50%+1 cannot be obtained, the candidate with the lowest number of votes shall be dropped from consideration, and the active members shall vote again.
 - iii. In the event of a tie, the ballot will be recast. If a tie still presents itself, the Officers will hold an exclusive Executive Board ballot in order to determine a winner. The board will determine a winner according to a 50%+1 vote.
4. All officers serve for a term of one calendar year, beginning in the month following elections and ending the month of elections.
5. No one involved in conducting and counting the elections may be an official candidate.

ARTICLE V: Financial Statement

1. Membership dues of \$0.00 per member will be regularly collected at the beginning of each fall semester. This will activate the member until the beginning of the next fall semester. However, as stated earlier, "A member may become active at any time, but all active memberships must be renewed at the beginning of each fall semester."

2. The funds will be spent at the unanimous discretion of the Executive Board. For reference, this may include hosting workshops and supplying pizza to special meetings.

If it later decided and announced that membership dues are no longer the amount shown in this section, this Constitution already offers the dialogue and support for this alteration. It will be well advertised if and when the cost of membership is altered.

In the event of a dissolution of the organization, any remaining funds will be donated to the Student Organizations Support Fund at The University of Tennessee, Knoxville.

ARTICLE VI: Amendments to the Constitution

A Constitutional amendment may be introduced in two ways:

1. By Members

Any member may introduce a Constitutional amendment at the conclusion of any meeting. At the following meeting, the active members shall vote on the amendment, as outlined in the article on voting.

2. By the President

In addition to member-introduced and member-approved amendments, the President shall reserve the power to revise the Constitution after consulting with the Executive Board. The decision must be unanimous.

If the amendment passes, it shall be sent to the university for approval.